ratify the Treaty, it met a fateful end. The outbreak of the new Cold War embittered the relations between the two states and disarmament missions received heavy blows.

10. ***The INF Treaty, 1987:*** This is the **Intermediate-Range Nuclear Forces Treaty** which was an agreement between the United States and the Soviet Union signed in Washington, DC by the US President Ronald Reagan and the General Secretary of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union, Mikhail Gorbachev on 8 December 1987. It was ratified by the United States Senate on 27 May 1988 and came into force on 1 June of that year. The Treaty is formally titled as *The Treaty Between the United States of America and the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics on the Elimination of Their Intermediate-Range and Shorter-Range Missiles*.

Before the Treaty opened for signature, a series of negotiations and tussle between the two superpowers took place. Finally, in January 1985, George Shultz, Secretary of State of the United States and Andrei Gromyko, the Soviet Foreign Minister agreed to have separate but parallel negotiations on INF, Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty (START), and defence and space issues as part of a new bilateral forum called the Nuclear and Space Talks (NST). Thereafter, formal talks started in March 1985 covering all the three areas.

Following the talks between President Reagan and General Secretary Gorbachev in Geneva in 1985, where they issued a joint statement calling for an “interim accord on intermediate-range nuclear forces” and Reykjavik, Iceland, in 1986, both sides finally cleared the obstacles to the INF Treaty. On 23 July 1987, Gorbachev announced the Soviet acceptance of “double global zero”, i.e., total elimination of INFs under NATO and the USSR, worldwide. Finally, the Treaty was signed on 8 December 1987 in Washington, DC.

The provisions of the INF Treaty were aimed at elimination of the ground-launched ballistic and cruise missiles with ranges between 500 and 5500 kilometres. This Treaty called for the elimination of Pershing II and GLCMs on the US side and SS-4, SS-5, SS-12, SS-20, SS-23 and SSC-X-4 on the part of USSR.

Scholars point out the novelty of the treaty, namely, its verification